

Forced Removal or Moved to Opportunity?

Labor Market and Migration Effects of Japanese Internment

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Abstract

This is the abstract.

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1 Introduction

1.1 Research Question

What was the effect of internment on wage growth?

1.2 Motivation

Different studies seem to disagree on the sign of the effect. How to square the differences?

- Who was hurt more by internment? Who could adapt?
- Mechanisms: migration, rural vs. urban, occupational change?

Why it matters: different implications for other related questions.

- Adaptation story is an optimistic take on forced migration; people are resilient
- But inequality of opportunity also matters; if only relatively men benefitted, only young benefitted, etc. matters for targeted policy

1.3 Contributions

1. Synthesize different findings around internment outcomes
2. Use more data to look at heterogeneous effects
3. Model migration decision after release from camp to identify tradeoffs of forced relocation

2 Historical Background

2.1 Immigration into US

2.1.1 Japanese Immigration

2.1.2 Chinese/other immigration

2.2 World War II Policies

2.2.1 Internment

- Evacuation
- Incarceration
- Confiscation
- Release

2.2.2 Other related programs

- Military service
- Bracero Program

3 Theoretical Model

3.1

4 Data

5 Empirical Model

6 Results

7 Conclusion